

PREMIUM SEO DELIVERABLE

SEO Audit & Strategy Report

A professional HTML and PDF report for www.fairlend.ca, built from the completed Codex SEO audit with inline evidence, charts, screenshots, and a print-safe structure.

WEBSITE

www.fairlend.ca

AUDIT DATE

July 14, 2026

BUSINESS TYPE

Online First Service Area Financial
Business / Ontario Private Mortgage
Brokerage And Mortgage Administration

PAGES REVIEWED

17 URLs reviewed

68

SEO HEALTH

- Fresh Lighthouse scored mobile 33-35 and desktop 56; the mobile run measured 10.89 s LCP and 3.10 s TBT under simulated throttling.
- Two internally promoted resource routes return 200/noindex shells with 66 server-rendered words and no H1 or topical body content.
- Financial YMYL pages lack page-level licensed reviewer identity, review dates, primary-source citations, and independently verifiable proof.

Generated from the shared premium
report standard in

`seo/references/premium-
report-standard.md`

Table of Contents

Domain: <https://www.fairlend.ca/>

Audit date: 2026-07-14

Overall SEO Health Score: 68/100 - Needs improvement

Business type: Online-first Ontario service-area financial business - private mortgage brokerage and mortgage administrator

Regulatory identity: Fairlend Management Inc. operating as FairLend Mortgage - FSRA brokerage #13827 and administrator #13828

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Executive Summary

17

PAGES REVIEWED

4421

HOMEPAGE WORD COUNT

10.89s

LCP

0.000

CLS

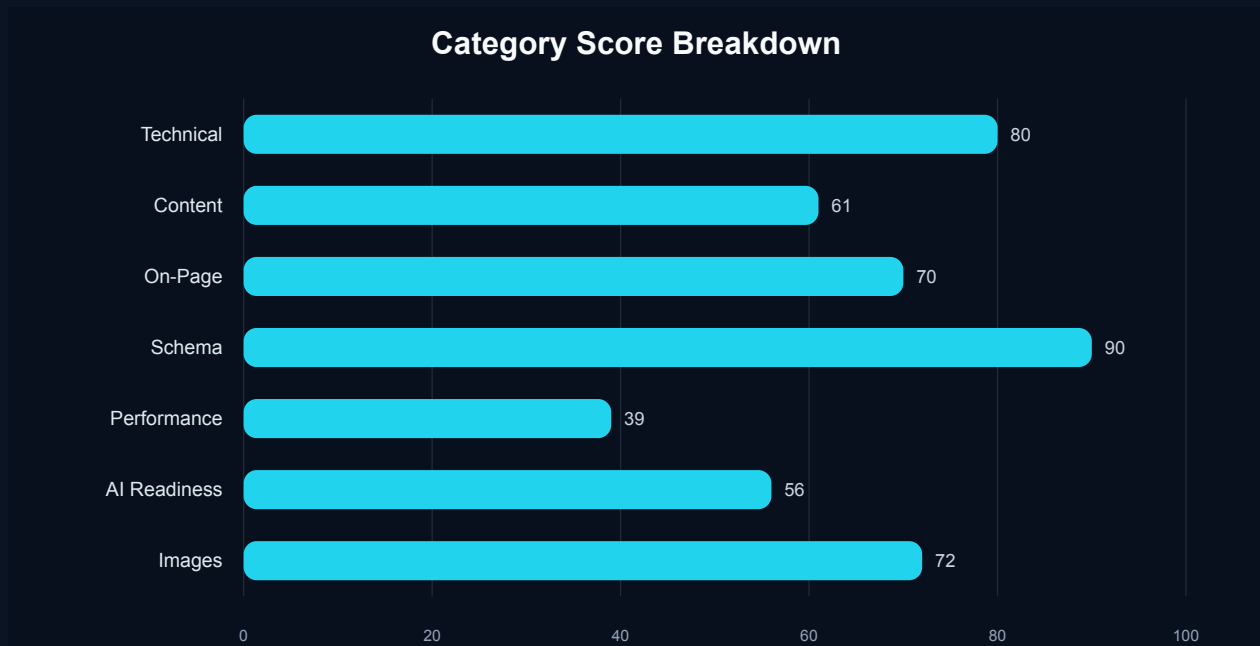
0

TITLE ISSUES

7

META ISSUES

CATEGORY SCORE BREAKDOWN



FairLend has a sound crawl and indexation foundation, clean canonicals, strong server-rendered schema, credible regulatory disclosure, and unusually detailed copy on its deepest borrower and investor pages. There is no verified site-wide indexing blocker, broken internal route, canonical failure, or robots/sitemap defect.

The score is held down by four material issues:

1. Fresh Lighthouse lab runs show poor throttled performance, especially on mobile. Mobile scored 33-35 with 10.89 s LCP and 3.10 s TBT; desktop scored 56. Real-user Core Web Vitals remain unknown because CrUX/GSC data was unavailable.
2. FairLend is a financial YMYL site, but money pages do not consistently show licensed reviewer attribution, review dates, primary-source citations, case evidence, or claim methodology.
3. The resource strategy is effectively unpublished. Two internally promoted topical routes are 200/noindex shells with only 66 server-rendered words and no H1, and the posts hub contains no published articles.
4. The mobile first-visit experience defers or covers conversion controls with an oversized consent surface and an oversized hero. The desktop identity is strong, but mobile users do not receive the same immediate CTA and trust stack.

No issue meets this audit's definition of Critical: a verified indexing block or penalty condition. The highest-severity items are High because they materially affect search performance, trust, or lead conversion without blocking the site from being crawled.

Scorecard

WEIGHTED CATEGORY	WEIGHT	SCORE	CONTRIBUTION
Technical SEO	22%	80	17.60
Content quality	23%	61	14.03
On-page SEO	20%	70	14.00
Schema / structured data	10%	90	9.00
Performance	10%	39	3.90
AI search readiness	10%	56	5.60
Images	5%	72	3.60
Weighted total	100%		67.73 -> 68

Supplemental measures outside the weighted formula:

SUPPLEMENTAL AREA	RESULT	INTERPRETATION
Visual / conversion UX	65/100	Strong desktop identity; mobile consent and CTA path need work.
Local SEO	48/100	Strong Ontario/FSRA entity signals; GBP, reviews, citations, and local authority are unverified or underdeveloped.
Search experience optimization	64/100	Page type and depth align with commercial intent; cost proof, trust, and mobile decision support lag competitors.
Backlink health	Insufficient data	A numeric health score would be fabricated. Evidence sufficiency is 14/100 because only 1 of 7 required factors was available.

Top Five High-Priority Issues

1. Mobile performance and first-party main-thread work

Fresh Lighthouse evidence:

PROFILE	PERFORMANCE	FCP	LCP	CLS	TBT	TRANSFER / REQUESTS
Mobile, simulated throttling	33/100	3.22s	10.89s	0.000	3.10s	2.28 MB / 73
Desktop, simulated throttling	56/100	1.13s	2.95s	0.004	425ms	2.67 MB / 111

An independent unthrottled Playwright observation measured good local LCP and CLS but confirmed the underlying weight: about 3,500 DOM nodes, 2.1-2.9 MB transferred, 0.55-0.71 MB JavaScript, and 2.0-2.9 s of long tasks. This reconciles the evidence: discovery and layout stability are good on a fast connection, while throttled mobile hydration and rendering are poor.

The dominant Lighthouse cost was first-party JavaScript. The deployed `36-7uqfsjqd4r.js` chunk produced about 7.77 s of boot-up work and a 2.69 s long task in the diagnostic run. The below-fold footer image was about 518 KB. Field INP and CWV status remain unknown.

2. Incomplete topical resources and misleading destination promises

These internally linked routes return 200 and `noindex, follow`, but expose only 66 parsed server-rendered words with no H1 or topical H2:

- `/cmhc-mli-select-multiplex-financing` - linked as "Reports & Data"
- `/resources/construction-draws-small-builders` - linked as "Builder Draw Guide"

The posts hub has only 44 parsed words and no published post URLs; `posts-sitemap.xml` is valid but empty. Other footer labels also over-promise their destinations: "Rate Sheet" points to a general private mortgage page, "Track Record" points to an investor page without a discrete substantiated track-record section, and "Mezzanine Capital" points to a broader institutional page.

This is not an indexation penalty because the two shells are noindexed. It is a high-priority content, internal-link, user-expectation, and AI-extractability failure.

3. Financial YMYL trust and editorial proof

Strengths include legal identity, FSRA licence links, direct contact information, explicit risk/no-guarantee language, a named principal broker, and substantive underwriting/exit discussion.

Material gaps on money pages:

- no visible written-by and licensed-reviewer system;
- no `datePublished`, `dateModified`, or last-reviewed date;
- few inline links to FSRA, CMHC, municipal, or statutory primary sources;
- no compliance-safe case studies or worked examples;
- experience/funded-volume claims lack scope, date, and methodology;
- little independent recognition or third-party authority.

Prioritize `/borrowers/private-mortgage-financing` , `/borrowers/institutional-mortgage` , `/investing/private-mortgage-lending` , and every future resource article.

4. Mobile first-visit conversion obstruction

The desktop hero presents the phone, consultation CTA, application widget, Toronto context, and authority file effectively. On the supplied mobile capture, the consent surface occupies roughly the lower 41% of the first viewport and covers the underlying conversion area. The remaining viewport is consumed by the large four-line heading and carousel card. The header phone action is icon-only, and the primary consultation/application CTA is below the fold.

Several measured mobile targets also fall below the 44 x 44 px heuristic. The issue is conversion and accessibility risk, not crawlability.

5. Missing defense-in-depth response headers

HTTPS, TLS 1.3, and HSTS are present. The sampled HTML response omits:

- Content-Security-Policy and/or `frame-ancestors` framing protection;
- X-Content-Type-Options;
- Referrer-Policy;
- Permissions-Policy;
- X-Frame-Options where CSP framing protection is not used.

`X-Powered-By: Next.js, Payload` also exposes implementation details. These are primarily security hardening items, not direct ranking signals.

Top Five Quick Wins

1. Recompress and responsively size the 518 KB footer image; lazy-load below-fold assets and map the high-cost deployed JS chunk back to source for dynamic imports and deferred animation/interaction work.
2. Publish complete server-rendered content for the two resource shells or remove/rename their links and redirect them until ready.
3. Add visible written-by/reviewed-by/date/source blocks to the three deep mortgage pages and standardize experience/volume claims with an as-of date and methodology.

4. Reduce the mobile consent surface, add a labelled 44 x 44 px mobile CTA, and move one compact FSRA/experience trust row into the first viewport.
5. Change the three embedded flow H1s to H2/form headings, shorten five high-value overlong descriptions, and add normal crawlable links to the `/borrowers` and `/investing` hubs.

Technical SEO

What is working

- `robots.txt` returns 200, permits public content, blocks admin/API/preview paths, explicitly allows OAI-SearchBot, and points to the sitemap index and child sitemaps.
- All unspecified AI/search crawlers inherit the permissive wildcard policy.
- `sitemap.xml` is a valid index; `pages-sitemap.xml` contains 17 canonical HTTPS URLs; `posts-sitemap.xml` is valid and empty.
- All 17 sitemap URLs return 200, declare `index, follow`, and self-canonicalize.
- A broader crawl tested 54 unique internal URL variants with no broken responses or internal redirect links.
- Critical title, description, canonical, H1/content, viewport, and JSON-LD elements are server-rendered.
- Random missing paths return a true 404.
- The apex and HTTP variants permanently redirect to the HTTPS/www canonical host.

Technical improvements

- Collapse `http://fairlend.ca/` from two redirects to one direct permanent redirect.
- Add accurate CMS-derived `<lastmod>` values: only 1 of 17 sitemap URLs currently has one.
- Confirm that the noindexed CMHC and construction-draw resource routes are intentionally withheld.
- Add the tested response-security headers described above.
- Remove `X-Powered-By` and evaluate HSTS `includeSubDomains / preload` only after validating all subdomains.
- IndexNow was not publicly verifiable. It is optional and does not affect Google indexing.

Content Quality and E-E-A-T

Strengths

- The three deepest commercial pages contain detailed, domain-specific explanations rather than generic mortgage copy.
- Borrower content covers timing, fees, payout terms, renewals, maturity, mortgage position, and exit strategy.
- Investor content clearly states that investments are not deposits, are not guaranteed, may be illiquid, and can lose principal.
- Partner and construction content demonstrates real knowledge of acquisition, zoning, budget, draws, working capital, and takeout.
- Privacy, terms, disclosures, and contact pages are substantive and accessible.
- No material near-duplicate page pairs were found in the 17-page indexable set.

Content gaps

Seven commercial/content pages expose fewer than 300 standardized parsed words, including the empty posts hub, investor/borrower hubs, and local financing pages. Thinness matters where the page promises a decision resource but omits eligibility, exclusions, costs, examples, sources, or next-step logic.

The content cluster should be built in this order:

1. Private mortgages in Ontario - complete cost stack, first/second position, exit strategies, bank-decline paths, renewals, payouts, and a worked borrower scenario.
2. Construction draws - working-capital math, reimbursement sequence, evidence checklist, delay causes, contingency planning, and a downloadable readiness worksheet.
3. Multiplex, garden suite, and MLI Select - municipality/permit sources, CMHC criteria, project-stage checklists, and compliant examples.
4. Investor education - direct mortgage vs MIC vs syndicated/fractional structures, LTV/mortgage position, liquidity, default/recovery process, suitability, and fees.

On-Page SEO and Internal Linking

Metadata and headings

- All 17 crawled indexable URLs have unique titles, descriptions, and canonical values.
- Three high-value pages expose two H1 elements:
 - `/borrowers/institutional-mortgage`
 - `/borrowers/private-mortgage-financing`
 - `/investing/private-mortgage-lending`
- Seven descriptions exceed 160 characters; the highest-priority rewrites are institutional mortgage (196), partners (177), private mortgage (168), investor mortgage (166), and borrowers (164).
- The homepage correctly has one H1, but its DOM exposes 24 H2s and 83 H3s while only 119 words appear inside the first `<main>` landmark. Responsive/interface duplication is weakening semantic containment.

Internal-link graph

The union of sitemap and link discovery produced 21 distinct routes: 17 indexable sitemap pages and four linked noindex routes. Four indexable sitemap pages were absent from the live internal-link graph:

- `/affordable-sustainable-rental-housing`
- `/borrowers`
- `/garden-suite`
- `/investing`

The two major hubs had zero parsed inbound anchors in the 17-page set. Add normal primary navigation, breadcrumb, and contextual links rather than relying on interface state or JavaScript interactions.

Schema and Structured Data

Schema is the strongest category. All 17 sitemap pages serve parseable server-rendered JSON-LD. The graph consistently includes Organization + FinancialService and WebSite; interior pages add BreadcrumbList, Service, or ContactPage where relevant. The organization entity includes legal name, phone, email, hours, Ontario/Toronto/GTA area served, and both FSRA licence records.

Improvements:

- add a stable WebPage node or appropriate subtype to standard pages;
- link it via `isPartOf` to `#website` and via `about / mainEntity` to the organization or primary service;
- add Person/author/reviewer relationships to published resources and reviewed money pages;
- keep FAQPage only for semantic/GEO value - FairLend is not eligible for Google's restricted FAQ rich result;
- validate the deployed graph with Schema.org Validator and Google Rich Results Test after changes.

Performance and Core Web Vitals

Performance is the lowest weighted category. Fresh Lighthouse lab evidence is poor and repeatable on mobile. The hero LCP image is discoverable, eagerly loaded, dimensioned, and prioritized, which indicates the dominant problem is not image discovery alone. First-party rendering/hydration work and total page complexity are the primary suspects.

Recommended diagnostic sequence:

1. Use the Next.js bundle analyzer and production source maps to identify the source modules behind `36-7uqfsjqd4r.js`.
2. Dynamically import below-fold animation, calculators, carousels, or heavy interactive sections.
3. Reduce duplicate responsive DOM and the approximately 1.0 MB decoded HTML document.

4. Recompress and responsive-size the footer waterfront asset; audit all eager below-fold requests.
5. Re-run Lighthouse mobile three times and use the median.
6. Connect CrUX/GSC and judge LCP, INP, and CLS only from 75th-percentile field data once enough traffic exists.

Do not present the old heuristic values of LCP 4.15 s, INP 500 ms, or CLS 0.310 as measured CWV. They were formulas derived from page shape, not browser observations.

Images

The crawl found 98 image elements, all with an `alt` attribute and all delivered through WebP/SVG/Next.js optimization. Seventy-seven use empty alt values. Many are correctly decorative clouds, textures, topographic backgrounds, repeated ornaments, or linked images whose adjacent text already names the destination.

Review the meaningful subset, especially:

- principal-broker headshot;
- project-path and parcel-sketch visuals;
- property-type/route choice illustrations when the image adds information beyond adjacent text;
- office, team, and construction evidence images.

Do not mechanically add keywords to every engraving. Keep true decoration empty and verify CSS aspect-ratio reservation before treating every dimensionless fill image as a CLS defect.

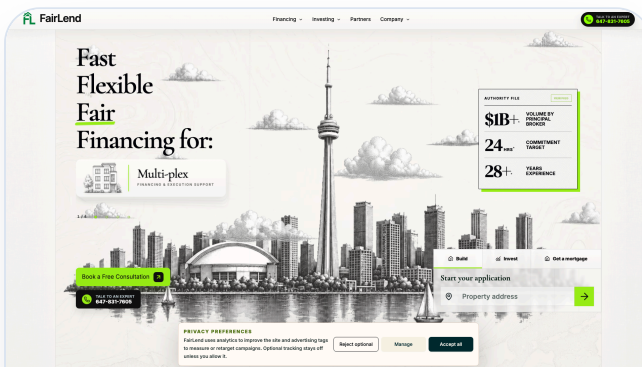
AI Search / GEO Readiness

Major AI crawlers are allowed and core content is visible without client JavaScript. Readiness is limited by the lack of source-backed self-contained answer blocks, semantic comparison tables, author/reviewer entities, publication dates, a published resource cluster, and `llms.txt`.

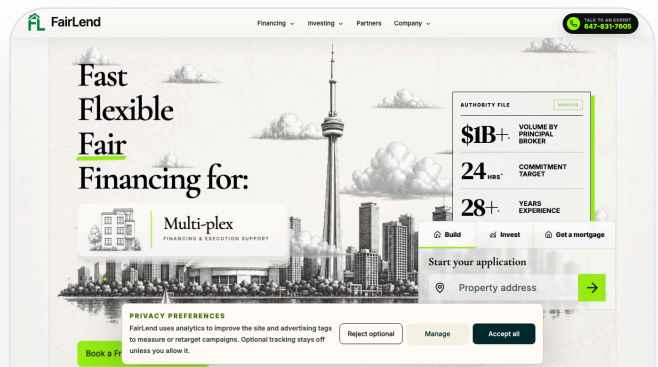
Recommended order:

1. Fix/remove resource shells and publish authoritative content.
2. Add licensed reviewer identity, dates, and primary-source citations.
3. Convert institutional-vs-private, financing-cost, draw-step, and investment-structure explanations into semantic tables and concise answer-first passages.
4. Build a disambiguated Organization/FinancialService/Person footprint with verified `sameAs` profiles.
5. Publish `11ms.txt` only after the linked pages are complete and authoritative.

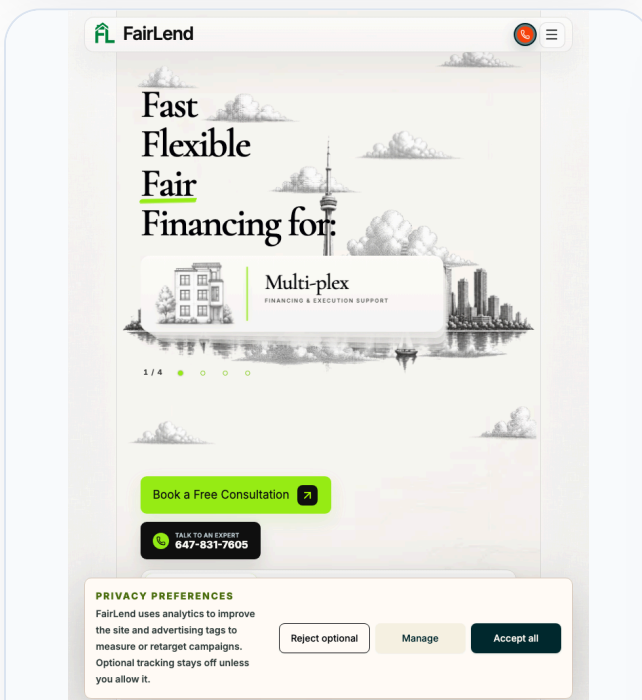
Visual and UX Signals



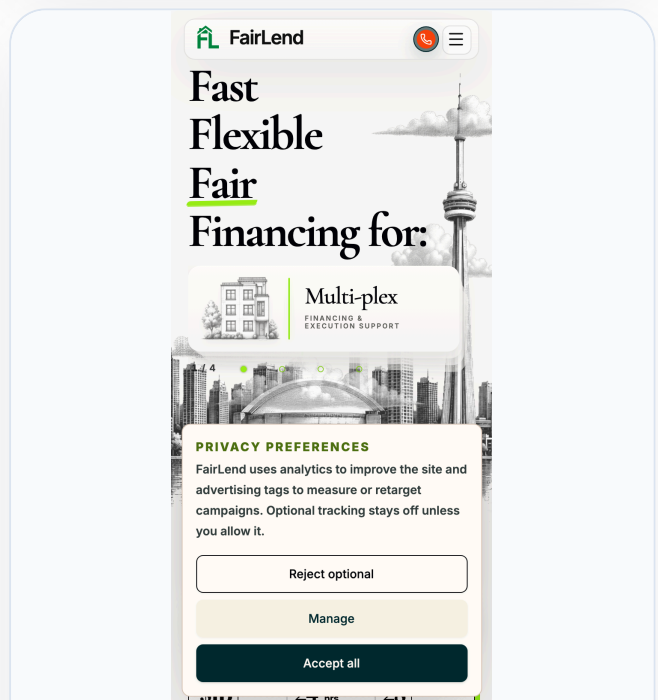
Desktop homepage render



Laptop homepage render



Tablet homepage render



Mobile homepage render

The page has a distinctive, credible desktop identity and strong Toronto relevance. Desktop users receive the brand, phone, consultation CTA, authority card, and application widget above the fold. Mobile users receive a large heading, one product card, an icon-only phone control, and a consent surface that covers the route to conversion.

The target private-mortgage page has the correct commercial/hybrid page type for its sampled SERP and strong objection handling. Its weakest audience is the cost-conscious comparer: the page discusses cost but lacks a compliance-reviewed worked scenario or calculator showing principal, mortgage position, term, illustrative interest, lender/broker/legal/appraisal costs, payment treatment, and payout assumptions.

Local SEO

FairLend is best treated as an online-first service-area business, not a claimed walk-in storefront. The site and FSRA records agree on the name and phone. The regulator lists an administrative/licensed address, while the site publishes Ontario/Toronto/GTA service areas without a visitor address.

Before changing address visibility, establish the real operating model:

- if the North York address is staffed and customer-facing, publish it consistently on the contact page, schema, and GBP;
- if it is administrative-only, retain the service-area model and do not expose or fabricate a public location for SEO.

GBP existence/configuration, reviews, local-pack rank, and profile completeness were not verifiable. Confirm ownership, primary/secondary categories, SAB settings, services, hours, photos, and review operations directly. Add only verified social/directory **sameAs** profiles and pursue credible Canadian mortgage, builder, real-estate, planning, and housing citations.

Backlinks

Backlink health is intentionally unscored. Moz, Bing Webmaster, DataForSEO, GSC, and a usable Common Crawl domain result were unavailable; only 1 of 7 required evidence factors was present. No referring-domain count, domain authority, anchor distribution, toxic ratio, follow/nofollow ratio, velocity, or disavow recommendation is claimed.

Establish a baseline with Moz plus Bing Webmaster, or DataForSEO, before making link-health claims. Then prioritize editorial links earned by useful Ontario financing research, DrawFlow/construction-draw guidance, multiplex/GTA data, and licensed expert commentary.

Evidence and Limitations

- Scope included 17 indexable sitemap URLs, four linked noindex routes, 54 internal URL variants, live robots/sitemaps/headers/schema, four viewport screenshots, fresh Lighthouse lab runs, and an unthrottled browser performance observation.
- No GSC, GA4, CrUX, GBP, Moz, Bing Webmaster, or DataForSEO credentials were available.
- PageSpeed API requests were quota-blocked with HTTP 429.
- Lighthouse is controlled lab evidence and cannot establish field CWV pass/fail or INP.
- Local and backlink results marked unavailable are not claimed absent.
- Recommendations involving rates, fees, returns, MLI Select, suitability, case studies, or outcome claims require licensed/compliance review.

Specialist Evidence Files

- `SPECIALIST-TECHNICAL.md`
- `SPECIALIST-CONTENT.md`
- `SPECIALIST-VISUAL-LOCAL.md`
- `crawl-all.json`
- `homepage-parse.json`
- `lighthouse.json`

- `visual-analysis.json`
- `screenshots/`

The implementation sequence, ownership, acceptance criteria, and validation commands are in `ACTION-PLAN.md` .

Action Plan

Source audit: 2026-07-14

Current weighted score: 68/100

Priority rule: Critical blocks indexing or creates a verified penalty condition; High materially affects rankings, trust, security, or conversion; Medium is a meaningful optimization; Low is backlog.

Critical - Immediate

No verified critical issue. The site is crawlable, canonical, indexable, and free of broken internal routes in the tested scope.

High - Complete Within One Week

H1. Reduce mobile first-party rendering and hydration cost

Owners: Frontend engineering, performance

Effort: 3-5 engineering days for the first pass

Evidence: Lighthouse mobile 33-35, 10.89 s LCP, 3.10 s TBT; desktop 56; high-cost first-party deployment chunk; 518 KB below-fold footer image.

Actions:

1. Enable the Next.js bundle analyzer for a production build and map `36-7uqfsjqd4r.js` to source modules.
2. Dynamically import below-fold animation, calculators, carousels, and interaction-heavy sections.
3. Remove duplicate responsive DOM where one semantic source can be laid out with CSS.

4. Recompress and responsive-size the footer waterfront image; defer it until near viewport.
5. Audit eager images and JavaScript requested before the first conversion action.
6. Preserve the current server-rendered title, content, canonical, and schema behavior.

Acceptance criteria:

- median of three Lighthouse mobile runs ≥ 70 ;
- mobile LCP ≤ 2.5 s and TBT ≤ 200 ms in the agreed lab profile;
- no regression in server-rendered SEO content;
- no horizontal scroll or broken hero/application behavior at 375 x 812, 390 x 844, 768 x 1024, and 1365 x 768.

H2. Resolve the two resource shells and destination-label mismatches

Owners: Content, compliance, frontend/CMS

Effort: 2-5 days per resource if publishing; under 1 day if redirecting/removing

Routes: `/cmhc-mli-select-multiplex-financing` , `/resources/construction-draws-small-builders`

Choose one outcome per route:

- publish a complete server-rendered resource with one H1, useful body content, licensed review, update date, primary sources, schema, and contextual links; or
- remove the promotional link and 301 to the closest complete page until the resource is ready.

Also fix the labels "Rate Sheet," "Track Record," "Reports & Data," "Builder Draw Guide," and "Mezzanine Capital" so each destination fulfills the promise.

Acceptance criteria:

- no internally promoted route returns a 66-word/no-H1 shell;
- every promotional anchor has a destination-specific section or accurately describes the target;
- any page switched to `index, follow` is added to the sitemap only after content/schema review.

H3. Add a licensed editorial trust system for YMYL pages

Owners: Principal broker/compliance, content, frontend

Effort: 2-4 days for the reusable pattern plus page review

Actions:

1. Add written-by, reviewed-by, last-reviewed, and source-note components.
2. Create a substantive principal-broker profile with role, experience, licences, areas of expertise, and regulator links.
3. Add relevant FSRA, CMHC, municipal, or statutory citations beside material program/regulatory claims.
4. Standardize \$1B+ , more than \$2B , 24 hrs , and 28+ years claims with scope, methodology, and as-of date.
5. Add compliance-safe worked examples and case studies that disclose assumptions and do not imply guaranteed outcomes.
6. Connect Person/WebPage/Article/Organization entities with stable @id values.

First pages:

- /borrowers/private-mortgage-financing
- /borrowers/institutional-mortgage
- /investing/private-mortgage-lending

Acceptance criteria:

- every material financial page shows a named licensed reviewer and review date;
- primary claims have adjacent source/method notes;
- schema validates with no broken entity links;
- compliance signs off before deployment.

H4. Fix the mobile first-visit consent and CTA path

Owners: Product design, frontend, privacy/compliance

Effort: 2-3 days

Actions:

1. Convert consent to a compact accessible bottom sheet with concise copy and equally valid accept/reject choices; keep Manage secondary.
2. Cap initial height so a labelled primary CTA remains visible.
3. Add a persistent labelled mobile CTA such as "Book consultation" or "Start application."
4. Pull a compact trust row above the fold: FSRA licensed, Ontario, and one supportable experience signal.
5. Make header, carousel, tabs, and CTA targets at least 44 x 44 px.

6. Reduce mobile hero size/leading enough to show a conversion action without losing the visual identity.

Acceptance criteria:

- first-visit consent does not cover the primary CTA at 360 x 800 or 390 x 844;
- keyboard/screen-reader flow remains correct;
- consent event semantics and privacy behavior are unchanged;
- one labelled conversion action and one trust signal are visible in the first mobile viewport.

H5. Add response security headers safely

Owners: Platform/security, frontend

Effort: 1-3 days including report-only observation

Actions:

1. Add `X-Content-Type-Options: nosniff` .
2. Add a restrictive `Referrer-Policy` .
3. Introduce Content-Security-Policy in report-only mode, collect violations, then enforce.
4. Protect framing with CSP `frame-ancestors` and/or `X-Frame-Options` where appropriate.
5. Add a minimal `Permissions-Policy` for actually used features.
6. Remove `X-Powered-By` .

Acceptance criteria:

- headers appear on HTML and error responses;
- no Payload admin, media, analytics, maps/address autocomplete, booking, or intake workflow is broken;
- CSP is enforced only after report-only violations are resolved.

Medium - Complete Within One Month

M1. Correct headings, descriptions, and semantic landmarks

Owners: Frontend, content

Effort: 1-2 days

- Change the embedded intake-flow H1 to H2/form heading on the institutional, private mortgage, and investor pages.
- Shorten high-value descriptions to about 145-160 characters on institutional mortgage, partners, private mortgage, investor mortgage, and borrowers.
- Ensure visible primary homepage content sits inside a single `<main>` landmark.
- Avoid duplicated desktop/mobile content trees when CSS can lay out one semantic source.

Acceptance criteria: one H1 on every indexable page; no duplicate metadata; primary content inside one main landmark.

M2. Repair the internal-link and sitemap relationship

Owners: Information architecture, frontend/CMS

Effort: 1-2 days

- Add normal crawlable links to `/borrowers` and `/investing` from primary navigation, breadcrumbs, and relevant deep pages.
- Add contextual links to `/affordable-sustainable-rental-housing` and `/garden-suite` or consolidate them if they duplicate stronger pages.
- Source accurate sitemap `lastmod` values from CMS `updatedAt` ; currently 16 of 17 omit them.
- Collapse the HTTP apex redirect to one direct hop.

Acceptance criteria: every indexable sitemap URL has at least one meaningful inbound link; accurate `lastmod` values; no sitemap URL redirects or noindexes.

M3. Extend the entity/schema graph

Owners: SEO/frontend, content

Effort: 1-2 days

- Add linked WebPage/subtype nodes to standard pages.
- Add Person author/reviewer nodes and connect future Article nodes.
- Retain Organization + FinancialService, WebSite, Service, ContactPage, and BreadcrumbList.
- Treat FAQPage as semantic markup, not a Google rich-result promise.

Acceptance criteria: Schema.org Validator and Google Rich Results Test complete without syntax/entity errors.

M4. Build answer-first GEO assets and `11ms.txt`

Owners: Content, SEO, compliance

Effort: 3-5 days after resource publication

- Add semantic comparison tables for private vs institutional, first vs second mortgage, cost components, draw steps, and investment structures.
- Write self-contained source-backed answers with dates and licensed review.
- Publish `11ms.txt` linking only to complete authoritative borrower, investor, construction, disclosure, and leadership pages.
- Add downloadable checklists/calculators where they materially help the decision.

Acceptance criteria: cited passages make sense out of context; every numeric/regulatory claim has a source/date; `11ms.txt` returns 200 and contains no draft/shell URL.

M5. Establish local search and review operations

Owners: Marketing/operations, compliance

Effort: 2-4 days plus ongoing review management

- Verify GBP ownership, category, service-area/public-office model, services, hours, photos, and review process.
- If the North York address is not customer-facing, keep the SAB address hidden and do not fabricate a storefront.
- Normalize Apple Business Connect, Bing Places, and credible Canadian mortgage/local directory profiles.
- Add verified social/directory profiles to `sameAs`.
- Strengthen Ontario/GTA language in service-page H1s naturally.

Acceptance criteria: business identity and phone are consistent; address policy matches reality; verified profile links are visible; reviews are handled policy-compliantly.

Low / 30-90 Day Growth Work

L1. Publish the resource cluster

Create licensed, cited clusters for private mortgages, construction draws, multiplex/garden suite/MLI Select, and investor education. Each resource needs a clear intent, stable URL, author/reviewer/date, Article/WebPage schema, primary sources, and links to the relevant commercial path.

L2. Establish a scoreable backlink baseline

Connect Moz plus Bing Webmaster, or DataForSEO. Capture referring domains, quality distribution, anchors, toxic indicators, follow/nofollow mix, geographic relevance, and new/lost velocity. Do not disavow links without verified link-level evidence.

L3. Earn authority through useful evidence

Turn DrawFlow, construction-draw guidance, multiplex/GTA research, Ontario financing datasets, worked scenarios, and licensed expert commentary into citation-worthy assets for builders, architects, planners, real-estate professionals, housing publications, and mortgage associations.

Validation Checklist

After each release:

1. Crawl all sitemap and internally linked routes; confirm status, robots, canonical, H1, and inbound links.
2. Run three Lighthouse mobile tests and use the median; record desktop as a secondary diagnostic.
3. Capture first-visit mobile, tablet, laptop, and desktop screenshots with consent visible and dismissed.
4. Validate schema with Schema.org Validator and Google's live test.
5. Inspect response headers on homepage, error, intake, media, API, and admin routes.
6. Re-check robots and all sitemaps.
7. Once credentials exist, record GSC index coverage/query data, CrUX CWV, GA4 organic conversion, GBP visibility/reviews, and backlink baselines.

Expected Score Movement

This is directional, not a ranking guarantee:

WORK COMPLETED	LIKELY CATEGORY MOVEMENT	WEIGHTED EFFECT
Performance first pass	39 -> 65-75	+2.6 to +3.6
YMYL editorial system + resource fixes	Content 61 -> 75-82	+3.2 to +4.8
Heading/link/metadata cleanup	On-page 70 -> 82-88	+2.4 to +3.6
WebPage/Person graph	Schema 90 -> 95	+0.5
GEO answer/source system	GEO 56 -> 72-80	+1.6 to +2.4
Meaningful image-alt cleanup	Images 72 -> 82	+0.5

Completing the High and Medium tracks should move the weighted score from 68 into roughly the low-to-mid 80s, assuming validation passes and no new regressions are introduced.

Visual Analysis Snapshot

H1 visible above the fold: Yes

CTA visible above the fold: No

Mobile viewport meta present: Yes

Horizontal scroll detected: No